Chinese was taken mainly on the advice given by Sen, who until then had not visited Tawang or any other part of NEFA.

Most officers in Military Operations (MO) were aware of the logistical problems being faced by formations in both NEFA and Ladakh, and the absurdity of the task was obvious right from the very beginning. In the absence of Kaul, the MO Directorate abruptly found itself out of the loop, reduced to the role of merely relaying orders on behalf of the officiating CGS, who, until the Dhola crisis, had no role in any operational matter. Lieutenant Colonel Pritpal Singh (MO-I) was aware that 7 Brigade had been peremptorily ordered to move from Tawang and concentrate post-haste on the Nam Ka Chu, after which they were supposed to push the Chinese back up the hill and across the Thagla feature. As per Krishna Menon's orders, there were no written records maintained, so it is not known who took this incredible decision. To make matters worse, the army chief's office now instructed the MO to prepare a signal addressed to all formations down the chain of command, ordering the capture of Thagla by 19 September.

The name given to the Nam Ka Chu/Thagla plan was 'Operation Leghorn'. Jogi Dhillon made it very clear that he was not open to any discussion on the issue. He was obviously enjoying his new-found proximity to Krishna Menon, and the chance to deal with operational matters, rather than the humdrum of logistics and other aspects that were actually his job. A Sapper, Jogi Dhillon was a high-profile officer who was otherwise shackled to his desk as Kaul's deputy. To top it off, Dhillon gave Palit a direct order forbidding him from discussing the issue with the COAS, telling him that from now on, the DMO's job was to make sure the orders were simply carried out without any delay.

Not one to give in so easily, Palit sent off a frantic letter to Bijji Kaul imploring him to cut short his Kashmir sojourn and return to Army HQ as there 'had been gross over-reaction to the Dhola incident on the part of all concerned and that his presence at Army HQ was now indispensable'.

The director of the Intelligence Bureau, B. N. Mullik, by then was fully aware that the original report on 8 September emanating from the Assam Rifles JCO had been exaggerated ten times, and the actual strength of the Chinese opposite Bridge 3 was between fifty and sixty. Though previous intelligence reports had placed a Chinese infantry battalion near Le (four kilometres behind the Thagla massif), recent confirmed reports suggested